

Note: Draft minutes are subject to corrections, additions, and deletions

September 28, 2026

Present: Anne Marie Galanis, Chair

Alan Barclay

Fred Diana

Patrick Sheridan

Molly St. Jeanne, SAU 90 Representative

Absent (excused): Mike Plouffe; Scott Blair, Bob Ladd, HBVD Representative Don Bliss,
Select Board Alternate Representative

The meeting/tour started at 9:30 a.m. at the Hampton Fire Department 140 Winnacunnet Rd. The Committee met with Chief McMahon and Deputy Chief Nathan Denio. The discussion initially focused on fire station maintenance needs at both the main station and the beach sub-station. Chief McMahon spoke to his budget, noting that 88% is allocated to personnel costs, with the remaining 12% covering all other expenses, including, but not limited to, building maintenance, training, computer software, utilities, and fuel. He discussed the challenges of making necessary building repairs during a default budget year. The department is currently fully staffed, although four staff members are out for various reasons. The cost of training tuition and class fees has increased. The overtime budget is underfunded, as the department must ensure adequate coverage regardless of the reason for an employee's absence, including sick leave, vacation, military obligations, and workers' compensation.

A question was asked about when a new ambulance will be required and the expected lifespan of an ambulance. The cost of ambulances comes out of the EMS fund, which is funded through insurance billing when an ambulance and its team provide services. Ambulance purchases are staggered. The next purchase is targeted for 2027, with delivery expected in 2028. The lifespan of an ambulance is approximately eight years.

The ladder truck that voters approved this year has been ordered and came in below expectations in terms of cost. It is expected to be delivered in 2028.

The Committee toured the EMS training lab, where staff practice and improve their skills in providing advanced lifesaving procedures.

The tour ended at 10:35 a.m.

Minutes prepared by A. M. Galanis